

Loans4India — Platform Flow v3.2

Oct 3, 2026 · @JP

Summary

The applicant gives consent and uploads documents. Loans4India does everything else.

We review the documents, pick the bank, enter the application on the bank's portal and track it. The bank does its own checks and makes every decision. When the bank disburses, we record it and reconcile our commission.

Loans4India is a Virtual Corporate DSA. It never lends, underwrites, sanctions, disburses or services loans.

What changed from v3.1

Area	v3.1	v3.2
Bank choice	Loans4India picks the bank	Same
Pre-submission notice	Notice and a 24-hour objection window before each submission	Removed. No extra screen or wait. The applicant sees the bank's name in their status once the application is submitted
Consent	Named partner-bank list plus a notice per submission	One consent screen at the start, covering documents, the purpose and the named partner-bank list
Applicant's work	Consent, details, documents, respond to notices	Consent, details, documents. Answer a bank query only if the bank asks for something only the applicant has
Attempt states	Included <code>NOTICE_PERIOD</code> and <code>OBJECTED</code>	Removed

v3.2 is complete on its own and replaces `Loans4India — Platform Flow v3` as the working baseline. Where the linked Lifecycle or RBAC specs give more detail, the spec wins.

VERIFY marks an India-specific legal or regulatory point to confirm with counsel and the bank before real data or launch. It's a validation item, not a legal conclusion.

Document control

Item	Detail
Version	3.2: JP's simplified flow (applicant consents and uploads; Loans4India does the rest)
Owner	Loans4India Product / Solution Architecture (name to confirm)
Status	Working specification, subject to product, engineering, operations and legal/compliance review
Approvers	Business owner, Product, Engineering/Security, Operations, Finance, Legal/Compliance (names to assign)
Linked specs	Loans4India — Application Lifecycle Spec (to be updated to v3.2) · Loans4India — RBAC & PAM Spec (MVP1)
Scope	Applicant journey, admin back office, bank portal entry, status model, compliance, operations, MVP1 and roadmap

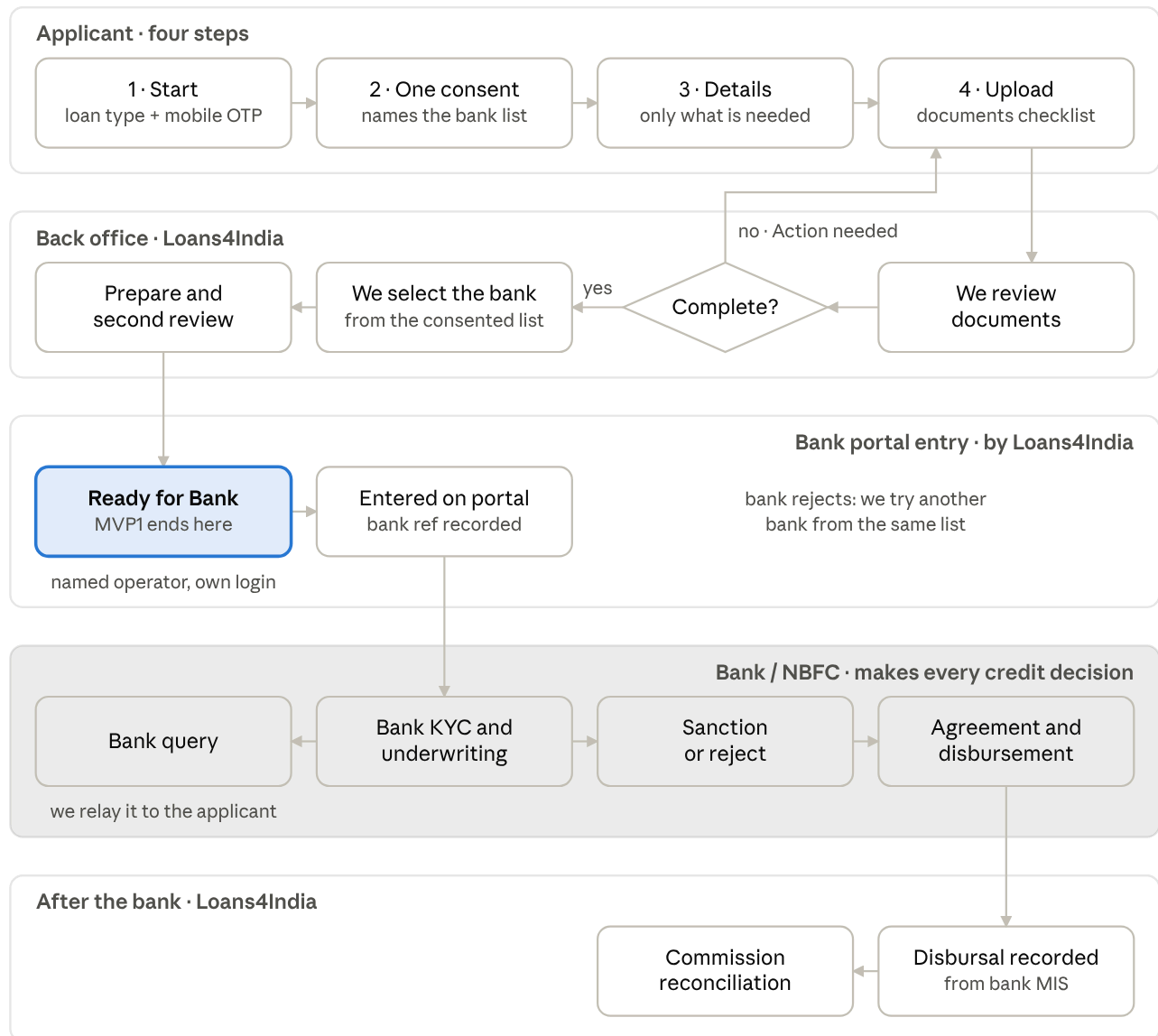
Design principles

Principle	Rule
Least effort for the applicant	Four steps: start, consent, details, upload. Everything else is Loans4India's job
DSA boundary	Loans4India sources, prepares and submits; the bank owns every lending decision and bank-side duty
Named recipients	Data goes only to a bank named on the consent screen the applicant accepted

Principle	Rule
Evidence-led statuses	A bank status is shown only when it is linked to bank evidence and its source
One bank per attempt	Loans4India picks one bank at a time. Re-routing creates a new attempt
Privacy by design	Minimum data; synthetic data until the go-live gate; retention and purge by validated rules
Progressive automation	Manual portal entry first; bulk upload or API per bank only with written approval
Auditability	Actor, action, time, reason, scope and before/after for every sensitive or state-changing action

At a glance

The applicant uploads; Loans4India does the rest; the bank decides



v3.2 flow · four applicant steps, then Loans4India and the bank

The top band is everything the applicant does. Everything below it is Loans4India's work or the bank's, with no extra screens for the applicant.

Responsibility boundary

Step	Applicant	Loans4India	Bank / NBFC
Consent	Gives it once	Records it with version and evidence	Defines what data it needs
Details and documents	Fills in and uploads	Collects only what's needed; stores securely	Sets the document list
Document review	Fixes anything flagged	Checks completeness, readability, expiry, name match	Does its own KYC later
Bank selection	—	Picks one bank from the consented list	Sets sourcing criteria
Portal entry	—	Named operator enters the application; records bank reference	Provides portal access
Processing and decision	Answers bank queries if asked	Tracks status; relays queries	KYC, underwriting, approval or rejection
Sanction, agreement, disbursement	Deals with the bank for signing	Records only what the bank confirms	Responsible
Commission	—	Reconciles against the agreement	Pays commission

Internal review improves file quality. It never replaces the bank's KYC or decision, and Loans4India never calls an application approved, sanctioned or disbursed until the bank confirms it.

User flow (applicant)

The applicant does four steps, then watches their status. Every screen works on a phone at 360 px width, in English and Hindi.

#	Screen	Applicant does	Platform does	Control
1	Landing / product page	Reads about the loan; may use the EMI calculator or indicative estimate	Shows "loan sourcing service, not a lender" and "no fee" in the header or footer; captures campaign, referrer and affiliate code	No bank names before agreements; estimate labelled "indicative, not an approval"; no bureau pull
2	Start	Picks loan type, enters amount and mobile	Sends OTP; on success creates the application (ENQUIRY) and checks for duplicates	OTP rate limits; never reveals whether another application exists
3	Consent	Reads one short screen and ticks the required box; optionally ticks marketing	Stores the exact text, notice version, bank-list version, time, IP and device	Nothing beyond the enquiry is processed without this tick; marketing is never pre-ticked
4	Details	Fills personal, employment, income and loan requirement	Shows only fields the product needs, marks mandatory vs optional, validates formats, autosaves	Minimum data; field-level change history
5	Documents	Uploads each item on the product checklist (camera or file)	Checks type, size and readability; scans for malware; stores privately; shows what's still missing	No public file links; Aadhaar masked; nothing extra requested
6	Review and submit	Confirms details and taps Submit	Freezes snapshot v1; moves to VERIFICATION_REVIEW ; sends a confirmation message	Applicant sees "Under review by Loans4India"

#	Screen	Applicant does	Platform does	Control
7	Status tracker	Checks progress any time after OTP sign-in	Shows the computed label, the bank name once submitted, and any open task	Only bank-confirmed bank statuses are shown
8	Action needed (only if raised)	Opens the task, uploads the fix or answers	Links the response to the issue, keeps old versions, returns the case to review	Message contains no personal data, only a sign-in link
9	Bank query (only if the bank asks for something only the applicant has)	Uploads or answers	Ops sends it to the bank through its channel	Task shows the bank's exact request and due date
10	Outcome	Sees in-principle, sanction, rejection or disbursement as the bank reports it; completes signing with the bank directly	Records bank evidence; on rejection, may try another listed bank	Bank terms, KFS and APR shown exactly as the bank issued them (VERIFY)
11	My Data and support	Withdraws, revokes consent, asks for access, correction or erasure, or raises a complaint	Opens a request or complaint case with an owner and deadline	Step-up check before disclosing or changing data

Returning users, authentication and sessions

- The applicant enters their registered mobile and completes OTP before any application detail or bank status is shown.

- OTP proves control of the phone, not identity. Sensitive requests (data access, correction, erasure, changing the mobile) need a step-up check, such as matching PAN or date of birth already on file.
- Sessions expire after configurable inactivity (15 minutes, *proposed default*). Sensitive actions ask for re-authentication.
- OTP attempt limits, resend throttling, abuse detection, session invalidation, and a secure support route for a lost number.
- Full PAN, Aadhaar, account numbers, salary figures and documents never appear in notifications or on screens before sign-in.
- One applicant can have several applications, each with its own ID and history. Records are never merged on a shared mobile alone.
- Staff sign in separately with named accounts and MFA (see roles).

Admin flow (back office)

From the moment the applicant taps Submit, Loans4India owns the work. Each step below names who does it, what they decide, and what the system enforces.

1. Intake, queue and assignment

1. The application enters the review queue in **VERIFICATION_REVIEW** with a unique ID.
2. The system runs duplicate checks (PAN, mobile, bank account, device) and consent validity. A possible duplicate is flagged for human review, never auto-merged.
3. The queue shows application ID, product, source, created and updated times, state, owner, priority, SLA age and open tasks.
4. The **Ops Lead** assigns an owner by workload and access scope. Reassignment needs a reason; history is kept.

2. Document and data review

5. The **Ops Executive** opens the application workspace: applicant summary, consent record, details history, documents, issues, timeline.
6. For each document: view, then **Accept**, **Reject with reason**, or **Request replacement**. Reasons: blurry, unreadable, name mismatch, expired, missing page, wrong document, other.

7. Data checks: completeness, consistency between fields and documents (name, DOB, address, employer, salary vs bank credit), document expiry, and PAN/name match through a licensed provider.
8. Any rejection or gap raises an **Action needed** task. The application moves to `ACTION_NEEDED` ; the applicant is notified; on response it returns to review. Old versions stay in history.
9. The reviewer can't mark anything as bank KYC complete or approved.

3. Bank selection

10. When review passes, the **Ops Lead** selects one bank and product. It must be on the applicant's consented list, have an active agreement and DSA code, cover the product, and accept the applicant under its sourcing rules.
11. The selection basis is recorded (product coverage, sourcing criteria, operational capacity). Never an undisclosed credit ranking or approval-probability claim.
12. If no listed bank fits: close as *no eligible bank*. If an off-list bank fits: send a one-tap re-consent request.
13. A submission attempt is created (`PREPARING`).

4. Preparation and quality gate

14. Map the canonical data to the bank's template version: fields, formats, document list and naming.
15. Run the checklist: 100% of required fields and accepted, unexpired documents.
16. A **second person** (Ops Lead or second reviewer, never the preparer) checks the package and approves.
17. The package, template and document versions are frozen. The application is `READY_FOR_BANK` ; the attempt is `READY_TO_SUBMIT` .

5. Bank portal entry

18. An **Authorised DSA Operator** (named, with their own bank login) enters the frozen package on the bank's portal exactly as approved.
19. They record the bank reference number, time, channel, and a screenshot or receipt.
20. Only then is the application `SUBMITTED_TO_BANK` and the attempt `SUBMITTED` . The applicant sees "Submitted to <bank>".

21. On portal failure: record the error, check the portal for a partial entry, retry (3 tries, *proposed default*), then escalate.

6. Tracking, queries and follow-up

22. Each submitted case has an owner and a next follow-up date. No update in 7 days puts it on the stale list (*proposed default*).

23. Bank status is updated only from bank evidence: MIS import, portal status, bank email. Source and evidence are stored each time.

24. **Bank query:** record the exact request and due date; answer from data we hold, or raise an applicant task for anything only they have; send it back through the bank's channel with evidence.

25. Escalate overdue queries, returned files and failed entries to the Ops Lead and the Bank/Partner Manager.

7. Outcome and closure

26. Record the bank-confirmed outcome: in-principle, sanction, agreement, disbursement, rejection or cancellation. Sanction and manual disbursement entries need a second-person check before the applicant sees them.

27. **Rejected:** if the reason doesn't apply to other banks, start a new attempt at another listed bank (at most 2 re-routes, *proposed default*). Otherwise close.

28. **Disbursed:** record amount, date and loan account reference; the application closes as *disbursed*; commission is calculated.

29. Every closure records a reason, the message sent to the applicant, and the retention or purge decision.

Admin back office: screens and modules

Module	What it does	Main users	MVP1?
Staff sign-in and PAM	Named accounts, MFA, sessions, role and scope assignment, access reviews, break-glass	Admin, Compliance & Audit	Yes

Module	What it does	Main users	MVP1?
Dashboard	Queue counts by state, SLA breaches, unassigned, Action needed ageing, stale bank cases, escalations	Ops Lead	Yes
Application queue	Search, filters, assignment, priority, SLA and exception flags; masked by default	Ops Lead, Ops Executive	Yes
Application workspace	One screen per application (panels below)	Ops Executive, Ops Lead	Yes
Document centre	Private storage, upload checks, malware scan status, watermarked preview, versions, review decision, access log	Ops Executive	Yes
Review and issues	Data-quality checklist, reason-coded issues, Action needed tasks, duplicate review	Ops Executive	Yes
Bank and product configuration	Agreements, DSA codes, products, template versions, document lists, partner-bank list versions, status maps	Admin (Bank/Partner Manager later)	One bank, one product
Preparation and package	Field mapping preview, checklist, second-person approval, frozen package	Ops Executive, Ops Lead	Yes
Portal entry log	Bank, operator, attempt, tries, bank reference, evidence upload, failure reasons	Authorised DSA Operator	Phase 2

Module	What it does	Main users	MVP1?
Bank status and queries	MIS import, manual status with evidence, second-person check, query tasks, exception queue	Ops Executive, Ops Lead	Phase 2
Finance	Commission schedules, expected vs received, payout import, adjustments, affiliate payables	Finance	Phase 2
Consent and data rights	Consent records, re-consent requests, My Data cases, purge jobs and logs	Compliance & Audit	Yes
Complaints	Grievance cases, owners, timelines, escalations	Compliance & Audit, support	Prototype
Holds and fraud	Hold queue, signals, review outcomes	Compliance & Audit, Ops Lead	Yes
Audit and reports	Event history, access logs, exports (approval-gated), operational metrics	Compliance & Audit, Ops Lead	Yes

Application workspace panels

Panel	Contents
Header	Application ID, state, product, source, owner, priority, created and updated, SLA age
Applicant	Contact and profile fields (masked by tier), employment, income, requirement
Consent	Notice and bank-list version, purposes, time, evidence, validity, revocation history
Documents	Checklist, version, scan status, review result and reason, access history

Panel	Contents
Issues	Open and closed Action needed items, duplicate flags, holds
Preparation	Selected bank and product, selection basis, template version, mapped fields, checklist, approver
Attempts	Each attempt: bank, state, tries, operator, bank reference, evidence, outcome
Bank updates	Bank-confirmed status history with source and evidence, queries and responses
Timeline	Every event, comment, assignment and field change
Finance	Disbursal reference, commission rule snapshot, payout match, adjustments (Finance only)

The one consent screen

With the pre-submission notice removed, this screen carries all the disclosure, so it must be clear and complete. It's one short screen with one required tick, not a wall of legal text. Full details sit behind a "Read more" link.

It must say, in plain words:

- **Who we are:** Loans4India is a loan sourcing service, not a lender. We don't charge you any fee.
- **What we collect:** your details and the documents listed for your loan type.
- **What we do with them:** check them, prepare your application, and submit it to **one** of these banks on your behalf: <Bank A>, <Bank B>, <Bank C> (named individually). We choose the bank, and you'll see its name in your status once it's submitted.
- **What the bank does:** its own checks and the loan decision. The bank may contact you directly.
- **If one bank declines:** we may submit to another bank on the same list, one at a time.
- **Your rights:** withdraw or revoke consent, access, correct or erase your data, and how to reach the grievance officer.
- **How long we keep data,** in one line, with the retention policy behind the link.

Stored with the consent: notice version, partner-bank list version, purposes, time, channel, IP and device, and the exact text shown.

Rules

- The list names banks individually and includes only banks with an executed agreement and brand-use permission. Before the first agreement, there's no list and no live intake.
- A bank added to the list later isn't covered by older consents. Those applicants need a one-tap re-consent before that bank can be used.
- Marketing and contact preferences are a separate, optional tick, never pre-ticked.

Status model

Three separate fields, each with its own history. The customer label is worked out from them for display.

Application state (Loans4India's workflow)

Code	Meaning	Applicant sees
ENQUIRY	Started; mobile verified	Application started
CONSENT_PENDING	Consent not given, or re-consent needed	Please give consent to continue
PROFILE_IN_PROGRESS	Details incomplete	Details needed
DOCUMENTS_PENDING	Documents missing	Documents needed
VERIFICATION_REVIEW	We're checking documents and data	Under review by Loans4India
ACTION_NEEDED	Applicant must fix something	Action needed: <item>
APPLICATION_PREPARATION	Bank selected; package being prepared	Under review by Loans4India
INTERNAL_REVIEW	Second-person approval	Under review by Loans4India
READY_FOR_BANK	Package approved and frozen	Under review by Loans4India

Code	Meaning	Applicant sees
SUBMITTED_TO_BANK	Entered on the bank portal with evidence	From bank status (below)
ON_HOLD	Paused for fraud, compliance or legal reasons	Under review by Loans4India
CLOSED	Ended, with a reason	Closed: <plain reason>

Attempt state (one bank per attempt)

Code	Meaning
PREPARING	Bank selected; package being prepared and reviewed
READY_TO_SUBMIT	Approved; operator authorised for this bank
SUBMITTED	Bank reference or receipt recorded
RETURNED_OR_FAILED	Portal failed or bank sent it back
OUTCOME_RECEIVED	Final bank outcome recorded
SUPERSEDED	Replaced by a new attempt at another bank
CLOSED	Ended by withdrawal or closure

Bank-confirmed status (set only from bank evidence)

Code	Applicant sees
RECEIVED	Submitted to <bank>
PROCESSING	<bank> is reviewing your application
QUERY	<bank> needs more information
IN_PRINCIPLE	<bank> has given in-principle approval (not a final sanction)
SANCTIONED	<bank> has sanctioned your loan; next steps are with <bank>

Code	Applicant sees
DISBURSED	<bank> has disbursed your loan
REJECTED	<bank> could not approve this application
CANCELLED	Application cancelled

IN_PRINCIPLE , SANCTIONED and manually entered DISBURSED need a second-person check before the applicant sees them. Removed in v3.2: AWAITING_BANK_CONSENT , NOTICE_PERIOD , OBJECTED and attempt CONSENT_PENDING . A bank outside the consented list is handled by re-consent at the application level (CONSENT_PENDING).

Bank portal entry and status tracking

The main channel is **manual entry on the bank's DSA portal** by our staff. Master DSA, bulk upload and API come in later, per bank, as v3 describes.

Portal entry rules

- Only a named operator, using their own bank-issued login, enters applications. No shared logins.
- No scripts, bots or RPA on the bank portal without the bank's written approval.
- The operator enters exactly the frozen package: no edits at the portal.
- After entry, record the bank reference number, time, operator and a screenshot or receipt. Only then does the application become SUBMITTED_TO_BANK .
- If the portal fails or the bank sends it back, record the reason; the attempt becomes RETURNED_OR_FAILED . Before any retry, check the portal for the earlier entry so nothing is submitted twice.

Tracking

- Each submitted application has an owner and a next follow-up date. Anything with no bank update for 7 days (*proposed default*) shows on the Ops Lead's stale list.
- Bank status comes only from bank evidence: MIS file, portal status, bank email, or later the API. Each update records its source and evidence.
- MIS rows are matched on bank reference first, then application ID. Unmatched or conflicting rows go to an exception queue and change nothing.
- A wrong status is corrected with a new event that supersedes the old one. Nothing is overwritten.

Bank empanelment, partner governance and handoff channels

Empanelment readiness

Banks vet a DSA before signing. Expect to supply most of the following; exact lists vary by lender (VERIFY with each bank):

- company documents: incorporation, PAN, GST, address proof, board resolution, authorised signatories
- director KYC and background declarations
- audited financials and bank statements; sometimes net-worth or track-record thresholds (a common reason to start under a master DSA)
- staff and sub-agent policies: background checks, training, code of conduct
- an information-security and data-protection questionnaire, including hosting location
- grievance arrangements and customer-facing disclosures

The result is a **DSA code per lender**, stored in bank configuration with the agreement dates, covered products, channels, commission terms and authorised operators. Only then is the bank added to the partner-bank list on the consent screen.

Partner governance

- **Agreement register:** status, effective and expiry dates, renewal owner, products, channels, data-use limits, commission schedule version.
- **Bank audits:** keep an audit-ready pack: SOPs, access lists, training records, complaint logs, consent samples.
- **SLAs and performance:** submission turnaround, query response time, file quality (returns per 100 submissions), conversion.
- **Offboarding:** stop new attempts at once, finish or hand back in-flight cases per the agreement, revoke operator access, remove the bank from new consent-list versions, and run data return or deletion.

Handoff channels

Channel	When	Minimum controls
Manual entry on the bank portal (default)	Bank grants DSA portal access	Named operator, own credentials, training, frozen package, reference and screenshot as evidence

Channel	When	Minimum controls
Master DSA / sub-DSA	While direct agreements are pending	Contract and data-sharing terms, named recipient, receipt evidence, status feedback
Bulk upload	Bank authorises batch files	Versioned schema, batch manifest, row-level outcomes, rejected-row handling
API	Bank authorises an integration	Contracted schema, authentication, idempotency, acknowledgements, retries, monitoring

No RPA, bots or scripted portal entry without the bank's written approval.

Disbursement and commission reconciliation

1. **Disbursement confirmed.** From the bank's MIS or a bank communication: amount, date, loan account reference. The application closes as *disbursed*.
2. **Expected commission.** Calculated from the commission schedule in that bank's agreement (product, rate, effective date). Rates are configuration, never hardcoded.
3. **Payout received.** Import the bank's payout file and match each row to a disbursed application.
4. **Reconcile.** Expected vs received vs outstanding. Short payments, unmatched rows and duplicates go to a finance exception queue.
5. **Adjustments.** Clawbacks, reversals and write-offs need a second approver and stay linked to the original entry. The ledger is append-only.
6. **Tax.** TDS (section 194H) and GST applied as validated by finance and tax advisers for the actual contract.

In MVP1, commission is design-only; the identifiers it needs (application ID, attempt ID, bank reference, agreement version) are captured from day one.

Affiliate payouts

Affiliate and sub-agent payables are tracked separately from lender commission: agreement, attribution window, payable rule, approval, payout status, disputes, reversals and fraud holds. TDS on affiliate payouts as validated (VERIFY). A payout is approved only

after the related bank commission is confirmed, unless the affiliate agreement says otherwise.

Outbound MIS to banks

Some lenders expect regular reports from the DSA. Per bank, configure:

- what's reported (for example, applications entered, pending queries, withdrawals), how often, the format and the delivery channel
- only fields the agreement permits, delivered securely with a receipt kept
- a reconciliation of our report against the bank's own MIS, so gaps are found early

Exceptions

Situation	What happens	Applicant's part
Document missing, blurry, expired or mismatched	Ops raises an Action needed task with the reason	Uploads a fix
Possible duplicate	Human review; never auto-merged or auto-rejected	None
Fraud signal	ON_HOLD for review; released by a different person	None, unless asked to verify
Portal failure	Retry the same package (3 tries, <i>proposed default</i>), then escalate	None
Bank returns the file (format or data)	Back to preparation or review, depending on the reason	Only if a document is needed
Bank query	Ops answers what we hold; anything only the applicant has becomes a task with the bank's due date	Provides the item
Bank rejects	If the reason doesn't apply to other banks, a new attempt at another listed bank (at most 2 re-routes, <i>proposed default</i>). Otherwise close	None; sees the updated status

Situation	What happens	Applicant's part
Bank needed that's not on the consented list	One-tap re-consent request	Taps to consent, or not
Applicant withdraws or revokes consent	Stop at once. If already submitted, tell the bank within 1 working day and keep evidence. Purge our copy per policy	Withdraws from "My Data" or support
Applicant goes quiet	Reminders at 2 and 7 days (only with contact consent); close as expired at 30 days (<i>proposed defaults</i>)	Resume before expiry

Dormancy, expiry and closure

An application waiting on the applicant is reminded, then closed as expired, so personal data isn't held indefinitely. All timers are configurable per product and stage (*proposed defaults*).

Waiting in	Reminder 1	Reminder 2	Closes at	Result
ENQUIRY or CONSENT_PENDING	none	none	7 days	Closed (<i>expired</i>); minimal data purged
PROFILE_IN_PROGRESS , DOCUMENTS_PENDING	2 days	7 days	30 days	Closed (<i>expired</i>); purge per policy
ACTION_NEEDED	2 days	5 days	15 days	Closed (<i>expired</i>)
Re-consent request for an off-list bank	1 day	3 days	7 days	Request lapses; back to bank selection
Bank query waiting on the applicant	Per bank due date	1 day before due	Bank due date	Operator tells the bank there was no response; the bank decides

- Reminders go only through channels the applicant has permitted, use approved templates, and never contain personal details.
- Expiry is a close reason, not a state. Timers pause while an application is ON_HOLD .
- An expired application isn't reopened. The applicant starts a new one, which may prefill non-sensitive fields they confirm. Documents older than the bank's limit must be uploaded again.
- Purge follows the retention schedule; only minimum audit evidence and data with a validated legal or contractual basis are kept.

Product catalogue and configuration

Every loan product is configuration, not code. Each bank layers its own template on top.

Product	Typical applicant data	Typical documents	Notes
Personal loan (salaried)	Employer, salary, existing EMIs	PAN, address proof, salary slips, bank statements	Suggested first product: simplest file

Product	Typical applicant data	Typical documents	Notes
Personal loan (self-employed)	Business type, annual income	PAN, ITR, bank statements	Income proof varies by bank
Business loan	Business vintage, turnover, GST status	GST returns, ITR, bank statements, registration	Entity KYC plus individual KYC
Home loan / LAP	Property details, co-applicants	Property papers, income documents	Long journeys; heavy bank-side legal and technical checks
Credit cards	Income, existing cards	Often minimal	Usually a separate bank arrangement (VERIFY)

Each product record holds: the inputs for any indicative estimate, mandatory, conditional and optional fields with the reason for each, document slots with expiry rules, covering banks and agreements, a template version per bank, and dormancy timers. Products launch one at a time behind the same go-live gates.

Acquisition, affiliates and sub-agents

Anyone who sources applications for Loans4India acts in its name, so they are onboarded, contracted and monitored. Lenders usually hold the DSA responsible for its sub-agents (VERIFY with each bank).

Control	Requirement
Onboarding	KYC of the affiliate and its principals; background declaration; bank account verification for payouts
Agreement	Scope, permitted channels and claims, no fees from applicants, data handling, confidentiality, payout terms, clawback, termination
Approved claims	Only Loans4India-approved creatives and wording; no bank names before agreements; no approval promises

Control	Requirement
Data access	A referral link or code only; never access to applicant data or the back office
Attribution	Defined windows and tie-break rules (last eligible touch within 30 days, <i>proposed default</i>); disputes logged
Monitoring	Conversion and complaint rates per affiliate; spot checks of ads and calls; duplicate or synthetic application signals
Offboarding	Link deactivated; outstanding payouts settled or clawed back per contract

Owned acquisition (SEO, content, paid ads, WhatsApp) follows the same claim rules. Tracking pixels and analytics run only with the visitor's consent where required.

Customer-facing language

Say	Never say
"Apply for a personal loan"	"We give loans" / "Get a loan from us"
"A loan sourcing service, not a lender"	"RBI-licensed DSA"
"Loans4India doesn't charge you any fee"	Any fee asked of the applicant
"Upload your documents and we'll take care of the rest"	"Guaranteed approval", fixed approval or disbursal times
"Under review by Loans4India"	Internal labels such as "Ready for Bank"
"Submitted to <bank>" (after bank evidence)	"Submitted" before the bank reference is recorded
"<bank> has given in-principle approval"	Calling a conditional approval a sanction
"Indicative estimate, not an approval"	Any eligibility figure presented as a bank assessment
Loan Application (from the first form)	Lead (internal word only)

Say	Never say
Bank names on the consent list (after agreements are signed)	Bank names, logos or "partner banks" before agreements

Data governance, consent and borrower rights

Consent records

- Versioned consent linked to applicant, application, purposes, data categories, **partner-bank list version**, time, channel, IP, device and the exact text shown.
- Processing consent is separate from marketing and any other optional permission.
- Before each attempt, the system checks that the selected bank is on the applicant's consented list version. If not, one-tap re-consent is required.
- If the purpose, data scope or channel changes materially, affected processing stops until new consent is given.
- Revocation is an event: future sharing is blocked at once and the withdrawal workflow starts.
- **VERIFY:** that one consent naming a bank list, with the bank shown in status after submission, meets DPDP's specific-and-informed standard and lender-disclosure rules. Fallback if not: an automatic SMS at submission, with no screen and no wait.

Minimisation, storage and location

- Each bank template marks every field and document as mandatory, conditional or optional, with the reason.
- Synthetic data only until the real-data go-live gate is approved.
- **VERIFY:** whether RBI digital-lending rules make Loans4India an LSP and limit what it may store. If so, documents may need to be purged soon after portal entry. This decides the document-centre design.
- **VERIFY:** India data-location requirements for hosting, backups, disaster recovery and support access.
- No requests for contacts, call logs, media or other device permissions; no biometrics.
- No Aadhaar authentication without the required authority; mask Aadhaar and never store the full number.
- No credit bureau pulls.

My Data requests

1. The request arrives through authenticated My Data, support or the grievance channel.
2. A case opens: type, references, received time, verification level, owner, target date.
3. The requester is verified proportionately, without collecting extra sensitive data.
4. It's classified as access, correction, erasure, nomination or other, with scope and any retention exception.
5. It's routed to the privacy owner and, as needed, operations, security or the bank contact.
6. It's fulfilled, partly fulfilled or declined, with documented reasons.
7. Actions, sources checked, downstream notices and completion evidence are logged before closing.

Withdrawal and revocation

When	What happens
Before portal entry	Stop at once; close as <i>withdrawn</i> or <i>consent revoked</i> ; purge per policy
After portal entry	Tell the bank through its channel within 1 working day (<i>proposed default</i>), keep the evidence, close, purge our copy. The bank handles its own copy

Retention, purge and audit

- A retention schedule by data category, purpose, state, recipient and legal or contractual need. Periods stay configurable until validated.
- Purge covers active storage, replicas, derived files, exports, caches and backups; any delayed deletion is documented.
- After a purge we keep only the consent log, audit trail, handoff evidence and commission records, pseudonymised where possible.
- Each purge records scope, time, result, exceptions and approver. A purge never erases the evidence that it happened.

Security, PAM and processors

- Deny-by-default access with case, team, bank, product and data-tier scopes, enforced on the server for every request.
- Named staff accounts, MFA for all staff, sessions with idle timeout, re-authentication before privileged actions.
- Named bank-portal credentials per operator, never stored in the platform; no pooled logins.
- Time-bound elevated access for document downloads, exports, configuration changes and break-glass, with reason, approval and review afterwards.
- Encryption in transit and at rest; secrets and keys kept apart from data; separate development, test and production; synthetic data only outside production.
- Logging of document views and downloads, exports, permission and configuration changes, status changes, approvals, portal entries and privileged actions. Append-only, tamper-evident audit store.
- **Exports:** explicit permission, stated purpose, volume limits, expiry, watermarking. No CSV export by default (the current website staff area has one and must change).
- **Processor register** for hosting, SMS and OTP, OCR, PAN/name check, analytics and other vendors: purpose, data fields, access, hosting location, subcontractors, security review, data processing agreement, deletion terms.
- **VERIFY:** CERT-In incident reporting (6-hour window) and 180-day log retention; an incident runbook with a decision owner, clock-start rule, evidence preservation and reporting steps.
- **VERIFY:** personal-data breach assessment and notification under the DPDP rules in force at launch.
- Backups, restore tests, vulnerability management, access reviews, incident response, business continuity and disaster recovery.
- The temporary Basic-auth staff login on the current website is replaced before any real data.

Fraud and risk controls

A DSA that sends a bank fraudulent files risks its empanelment, so fraud gets its own controls. A flag always means a person reviews it. It never means an automatic rejection or a credit judgement.

Risk	Signals	Control
Tampered or forged documents	Edited PDFs, metadata mismatch, inconsistent fonts or totals, salary slip vs bank credit mismatch	Reviewer checklist; OCR consistency checks where permitted; ON_HOLD for review
Identity misuse	PAN/name mismatch, mobile recently changed, address mismatch across documents	Licensed PAN/name check; step-up verification; hold
Synthetic or duplicate applications	Same device, IP, bank account or employer across unrelated applicants; velocity spikes	Device and velocity signals; duplicate review queue
Affiliate fraud	Fake referrals, recycled applicants, abnormal conversion or complaint rates	Affiliate monitoring; payout holds; clawback
Insider misuse	Unusual searches, bulk views, off-hours downloads, data sent to personal email	Scoped access, view logging, export controls, alerts, access reviews
Impersonation of Loans4India	Fake agents asking applicants for fees	Public "we never charge fees" notice; complaint category; takedown process

Review outcomes: release, ask for more information, close as *rejected internally* with a reason, or report to the bank where the agreement requires it (VERIFY). The applicant is never told about internal fraud signals beyond what's needed.

Communications and grievances

Messages the applicant receives

Trigger	Channel	Content (no personal data)
OTP	SMS	OTP only
Application submitted for review	SMS, email	Reference number, "under review"

Trigger	Channel	Content (no personal data)
Action needed	SMS, email	"Please sign in to complete a task"
Submitted to bank	SMS, email, status page	Bank name and "the bank may contact you"
Bank query	SMS, email	"Your bank needs more information; please sign in"
Bank outcome	SMS, email	In-principle, sanction, rejection or disbursal, as the bank confirmed
Reminder, expiry, withdrawal confirmation	SMS, email	As per the dormancy rules
Complaint acknowledgement	SMS, email	Case number and expected response date

- Templates are approved and versioned, in English and Hindi first.
- Application messages are kept apart from marketing, with channel-specific preferences.
- **VERIFY:** TRAI DLT registration of sender IDs and templates, consent and preference handling, DND scrubbing.
- **VERIFY:** calling-hour limits, DSA conduct rules, staff scripts and permitted call purposes; consent before recording calls.
- Every message and call attempt is logged with template version, channel, time and delivery result.

Complaints and grievances

- A disclosed grievance officer and channel; every complaint becomes a case with ID, category, severity, owner, response target, escalation path and resolution evidence.
- Acknowledgement, response and escalation timelines are set after validating regulatory and contract requirements (VERIFY).
- Complaints about a bank's decision are routed to that bank's grievance channel, and the handover is recorded.
- Overdue cases and recurring root causes are tracked; complaint records are restricted to authorised roles.

Roles, RBAC and separation of duties

MVP1 starts with four role groups; the full action matrix, data tiers and approval pairs are in [Loans4India — RBAC & PAM Spec \(MVP1\)](#) . The fourth group is **Compliance & Audit** (proposed); Finance joins in Phase 2.

Role group	Folds in	Can	Can't
Admin / PAM Owner	User Master, System Admin, Bank/Partner Manager (configuration only)	Users, roles, scopes, MFA, bank and product configuration, consent-list versions, access reviews	Case work; activating its own changes or grants
Ops Lead	Operations Lead, second reviewer	Assign, select the bank, approve packages, reopen, place holds, escalate	Approve a package they prepared; change roles or commission terms
Ops Executive	Application Ops, Document Reviewer, Customer Support (MVP1)	Review documents, raise Action needed, prepare packages, answer applicant queries on own cases	Downloads, exports, configuration, bank portal without operator authorisation
Compliance & Audit	Compliance/Privacy, Fraud/Risk	Consent and data-rights cases, holds, audit review, access-review sign-off, masked export with approval	Case decisions

Phase 2 roles: Authorised DSA Operator (portal entry), Finance / Reconciliation, Acquisition / Channel Manager. Later: Bank/Partner Manager, Customer Support, Reviewer, Fraud and Reporting split out as volume grows.

Separation of duties (enforced by the system): preparer vs approver; hold placer vs releaser; configuration drafter vs activator; access requester vs approver; download requester vs approver. For a small team, a named outside approver (founder, board member or adviser with an approval-only account) is used, never self-approval.

People, training and conduct

Banks expect DSA staff to be vetted and trained, and hold the DSA responsible for its people. This matters more in v3.2, because our staff do all the work for the applicant.

- **Before access:** identity and address verification, background or reference check (VERIFY each bank's requirement), signed confidentiality agreement and code of conduct.
- **Training before go-live, refreshed yearly:** the DSA boundary and what never to promise, data protection and consent, fraud awareness, complaint handling, each bank's portal process, phone and messaging rules.
- **Conduct:** no fees from applicants, no pressure selling, calls only within permitted hours, always identify as Loans4India and never as the bank, no personal phones or email for applicant data.
- **Identification:** staff who contact applicants carry a verifiable Loans4India ID; applicants can check it through the official support number.
- **Joiners, movers, leavers:** access granted on the start date, changed on role change, removed on the last day, including bank-portal credentials.
- **Records:** training completion, signed policies and checks are kept for bank audits.

AI and automation policy

AI may help our staff prepare files faster. It never makes or implies a credit decision.

Allowed (with controls)	Not allowed
OCR and data extraction, with a person confirming the fields	Credit scoring, approval probability or ranking applicants
Document quality checks (blur, expiry, missing page)	Automated rejection without a person
Drafting messages for staff to review	Free-form AI chat giving applicants eligibility or rate advice
FAQ assistant answering from approved content, with hand-off to a person	Sending personal data to AI vendors not on the processor register, or that train on it
Fraud signals that route cases to people	Scripted or AI-driven entry on bank portals without written bank approval

Controls: every AI vendor on the processor register, with India hosting and no-training terms confirmed. Outputs that touch an application are logged with the model version and a human confirmation. T2 and T3 data stay out of prompts unless the use is approved. Each new use case is reviewed by Compliance & Audit before launch.

Non-functional requirements

All targets are *proposed defaults*, to be confirmed with engineering.

Area	Target
Availability	Applicant site and back office 99.5% monthly in Phases 1–2; maintenance outside 8am–10pm IST
Performance	Pages usable within 3 seconds on a mid-range Android phone over 4G; uploads to 10 MB with progress and resume
Applicant effort	The four applicant steps finish in under 10 minutes with documents ready
Recovery	Backups at least daily; restore tested quarterly; recovery point 24 hours, recovery time 8 hours in Phase 1

Area	Target
Monitoring	Uptime, error rates, queue ages, failed jobs (purge, imports, reminders) and security events alert a named owner
Mobile-first	Every applicant flow works at 360 px; back office laptop-first
Languages	English and Hindi at launch; regional languages by demand
Accessibility	WCAG 2.1 AA on applicant pages
Environments	Separate development, test and production; synthetic data outside production; deploys only through the pipeline
Scalability	Bank and product differences live in configuration, not code
Auditability	Audit events written in the same transaction as the change; tamper-evident storage

Legal and corporate setup

These must exist before real applicants or bank onboarding; most banks ask for them during empanelment.

- **Entity:** the legal entity that signs DSA agreements, with PAN, GST registration and a bank account. The brand in use (LoansForIndia for now) is disclosed alongside the legal name.
- **Brand protection:** trademark search and filing (classes 35 and 36); domains registered. The final name is still open.
- **Agreement templates:** bank Corporate DSA agreement (the bank's paper, reviewed by counsel), master DSA/sub-DSA agreement, affiliate agreement, processor data processing agreement, staff confidentiality agreement.
- **Customer-facing legal pages:** terms, privacy notice, consent text with the bank list, grievance policy and officer, fee disclosure, "not a lender" disclosure. Drafts exist on the website, marked *draft* pending counsel review.

- **Internal policies:** information security, data retention, incident response, code of conduct, complaints, fraud, AI use.
- **Insurance (consider):** cyber liability and professional indemnity, often asked about by lenders.

MVP1 scope and acceptance tests

MVP1 is the secure foundation on synthetic data. It ends at **Ready for Bank**; there's no live portal entry.

In scope	Out of scope
OTP start, the one consent screen (sample bank list), details, document upload, review-and-submit, status tracker	Real applicant data before the go-live gate
Staff sign-in with MFA; four role groups with server-side scopes; audit trail	Full specialist-role suite
Queue, assignment, application workspace, document review, Action needed, duplicate review, holds	Live portal entry, MIS import, bulk upload, API
One product (salaried personal loan) and one bank template; bank selection; preparation; second review; Ready for Bank	Commission engine, payout imports, affiliate payouts (identifiers captured only)
Consent records, re-consent request, My Data and complaint flows (prototype), purge job on synthetic data	Credit scoring, bureau pulls, approval-probability claims

Acceptance tests

1. An applicant can finish OTP, consent, details and documents on a phone in one sitting.
2. Without the consent tick, nothing beyond the enquiry is stored or processed.
3. The consent record stores the exact text, notice version and bank-list version.
4. Staff can see and do only what their role and scope allow, through the UI and direct API calls.
5. A document view, unmask, download request, approval, export, configuration change and state change each write an audit event.

6. A bank outside the applicant's consented list can't be selected without re-consent.
7. Ready for Bank is refused while any required field or document is missing, or if the approver prepared the package.
8. `SUBMITTED_TO_BANK` can't be set without a bank reference and evidence (tested in the schema).
9. The applicant never sees an internal label, or a bank status the bank hasn't confirmed.
10. Reminders go only with contact consent; applications close on schedule; timers pause during holds.
11. Withdrawal and revocation stop processing at once and schedule a purge; the purge log shows what was kept and why.
12. A duplicate flag never merges or rejects on its own, and never shows one applicant's data to another.
13. A bank template can be changed and versioned without code; completeness is checked against the active version.
14. Storage, retention, purge, data location and the processor design pass the legal, compliance and security gate before any real data.

The Lifecycle and RBAC specs add their own detailed tests.

Roadmap and release gates

Automation is added per bank, never assumed globally. Manual portal entry stays as a documented fallback.

Phase	What goes live	Entry gate	Exit evidence
1. MVP1 foundation	Everything in MVP1 scope on synthetic data	Scope, architecture and test plan approved	Acceptance tests pass; security and privacy design reviewed

Phase	What goes live	Entry gate	Exit evidence
2. First bank, manual portal entry	Real applicants for one bank and product; named operators; MIS tracking; reconciliation; Finance and DSA Operator roles	Executed agreement and DSA code; counsel sign-off on consent text and bank list; LSP storage decision; vetted, trained operators; grievance officer; retention and incident setup	Bank SOP, operator access, entry evidence, exception and reconciliation process, first bank audit pack
3. Digital handoff per bank	Bulk upload or API where the bank allows; status import	Bank's written approval; tested interface; credentials; retry and idempotency	End-to-end test evidence; monitoring; incident and rollback readiness
4. Several banks and affiliates	Re-routing across banks; affiliates and channel payouts	Each bank passes Phases 2–3; multi-lender and routing rules approved	Per-bank readiness; performance monitoring; periodic partner review

Compliance validation register (VERIFY)

Confirm each item with counsel and the relevant bank against the rules in force at launch. This document is not legal advice or bank approval.

Item	Question for counsel / bank	Blocks
One-screen consent with a bank list (new in v3.2)	Does one consent naming a list of banks, with the chosen bank shown only in status after submission, meet DPDP's specific-and-informed standard and lender-disclosure rules? If not, is an automatic SMS at submission enough?	Real data; go-live

Item	Question for counsel / bank	Blocks
LSP classification and storage	Is Loans4India an LSP? Which borrower data and documents may it store, where and for how long?	Document storage design
Data location and device permissions	Which location rules apply? Confirm no contacts, call-log or media permissions and no biometrics	Hosting; app design
CERT-In and breach reporting	Applicability, reporting clock, recipient, log retention, responsibilities per entity and processor	Incident runbook
Data-principal rights	Rights, identity checks, timelines, exceptions, nomination; split with banks	My Data; support
TRAI DLT and calling conduct	Registration, templates, DND, calling hours, staff conduct, call-recording consent	SMS and calling
Fees and disclosures	Lender-paid model confirmed; any applicant fee prohibited or disclosable?	Pricing; copy
Bureau access and estimates	No bureau pull in scope; review the indicative-estimate wording	Eligibility UI
Offers, KFS and APR	How lender terms and the KFS reach the applicant; multi-lender display duties	Outcome screens
Staff and sub-agent requirements	Each bank's vetting, training and record requirements	Empanelment; affiliates
Credit cards	Whether card sourcing runs under a separate arrangement	Product catalogue
Tax	TDS, GST and invoicing on commission and affiliate payouts	Finance

Operational metrics

These measure the workflow, never an applicant's creditworthiness.

Metric	Definition
Applicant drop-off	Applications stalling at each of the four steps, by product and channel
Time to submit	Time from start to the applicant tapping Submit
First-pass completeness	Share passing document review without an Action needed task
Review turnaround	Submit to review decision; review to Ready for Bank
Action needed ageing	Open tasks by age, reason and owner
Portal entry turnaround	Ready for Bank to Submitted to Bank
File quality	Bank returns per 100 submissions, by reason
Bank status freshness	Age of the latest bank update; stale cases
Bank query turnaround	Query received to response returned to the bank
Conversion	Submitted to sanctioned to disbursed, by bank and product (bank-confirmed only)
Complaint and data-rights turnaround	Acknowledgement and resolution time; overdue cases
Cost per application by channel	Acquisition plus processing cost per valid application
Commission reconciliation	Expected, received, outstanding, discrepancy ageing, clawbacks
Security and access	Access reviews, exports, access exceptions, incidents

Open decisions

Owners and due dates are blank until assigned.

Decision	Owner	Blocks	Status
Counsel sign-off on the one-screen consent with a bank list	Legal + Product	Real data	Open, critical
LSP classification and document storage	Legal + Security + Bank	Document storage build	Open, critical
Direct Corporate DSA or start under a master DSA	Business + Legal	Phase 2	Open
First bank and product	Business	Phase 2	Open
Fourth MVP1 role: Compliance & Audit or Finance	Business + Ops	MVP1 build	Proposed: Compliance & Audit
Outside second approver for a small team	Business	Production	Open, critical
Processors: hosting, OTP/SMS, OCR, PAN/name check	Security + Legal	MVP1 integrations	Open
Dormancy timers and re-route limit	Product + Ops + Compliance	MVP1 build	Proposed: 30 days; 2 re-routes
Grievance officer and data-rights procedures	Compliance	Customer go-live	Open
Fee policy, KFS handling, estimate wording	Business + Legal	Customer go-live	Open
Incident and breach runbook	Security + Legal	Production	Open
Final brand name and trademark	Business	Public launch	Open
Update the Lifecycle Spec to v3.2	Product	MVP1 build	To do

Change log

Version	Date	Change
3.2	3 Oct 2026	Simplified flow: the applicant consents and uploads; Loans4India does the rest. Expanded to full v3 depth: detailed user and admin flows, admin screens and workspace, empanelment, affiliates, data governance, security, fraud, communications, roles, people, AI, non-functional requirements, legal, register, metrics, entities. Pre-submission notice and objection window removed. One consent screen names the bank list. Off-list banks need re-consent. Attempt states <code>NOTICE_PERIOD</code> , <code>OBJECTED</code> and <code>CONSENT_PENDING</code> removed, along with application state <code>AWAITING_BANK_CONSENT</code>
3.1	3 Oct 2026	Applicant no longer picks the bank; named-bank list plus a pre-submission notice
3.0	3 Oct 2026	Three-field status model; nine new verticals
2.0	3 Oct 2026	Virtual Corporate DSA model
1.0	2 Oct 2026	Marketplace flow (retired)

Appendix: core entities and minimum event record

Entity	Purpose and key relationships
Applicant	Contact and OTP authentication link; minimal sensitive attributes
LoanApplication	Canonical record: product, requested terms, attribution, owner, application state
SubmissionAttempt	One bank per attempt: bank, product, consent-list version, package version, operator, tries, evidence, bank reference, attempt state
BankStatusEvent	Bank-confirmed status per attempt, source, evidence, import details, correction lineage

Entity	Purpose and key relationships
ConsentRecord	Exact text, notice and bank-list version, purposes, status, evidence, revocation
PartnerBankList	Versioned list of banks shown on the consent screen, per product
DocumentRecord	Metadata, version, tier, scan status, review result and reason, retention decision
ReviewTask	Action needed, bank-query and duplicate tasks: owner, due date, resolution, evidence
Product	Fields, document slots, timers and covering banks per product
BankConfiguration	Agreement, DSA code, products, template versions, channels, authorised operators, status map
Affiliate	Onboarding KYC, agreement, referral codes, attribution rules, payout status
DataRequestCase	Access, correction, erasure or nomination request lifecycle
ComplaintCase	Grievance record, category, owner, target, escalation, resolution
CommunicationEvent	Template version, channel, recipient reference, permission basis, delivery result
ProcessorRecord	Vendor, purpose, data categories, hosting, contract, deletion terms
CommissionEntry / AffiliatePayable	Agreement-based receivable or approved payable, with reconciliation and adjustment lineage
StaffRecord	Checks, training, signed policies, role history, bank-portal operator authorisations
AuditEvent	Append-only, tamper-evident, privacy-minimised event

Minimum event record: event ID; application ID; attempt ID where relevant; actor or service; role and scope; event type; prior and new value; reason code and note; time; source or channel; consent and bank-list version where relevant; package and template version; evidence reference; approval reference; correlation ID; outcome or error. No document contents or T2/T3 values in event payloads.